

History of the Great Trail: From the Forks of the Ohio to the Tuscarawas Valley by Gary Winterburn

improvements at Fort Duquesne. De Lery made the following journal entry in April of 1755, when he was 18 miles west of the Forks of the Ohio.

"5th, Saturday....For one half the distance one goes through woods along the Oyo River; then one goes on the beach for two leagues and then enters the woods, where the road is good. The beach is followed only when the water is low, to avoid the mountains and rocky ravines on the road through the woods."

For most of the distance through Allegheny County, the trail remains on the first or second terrace, above the Ohio River.

When the Great Trail crosses Big Sewickly Creek, it also crosses into Beaver County, Pennsylvania. Following roughly what is now Ohio River Boulevard or the Old Beaver Road, the trail began its approach to the famous Indian stronghold of Logstown or Chiningue, as it was known to the French. Originally, the old trail probably remained on the first terrace continuing along the Ohio River, but after Chief Kakowatchiky settled his Shawnee Clan at the new Logstown, built on the second terrace about 1744, the trail was probably re-routed up the bank. The Moravian missionary, Christian Frederick Post, wrote on December 2, 1758 while traveling from Sawkunk, the Indian village at Beaver, to the Forks of the Ohio:

"I, with my companion, Ketiuscund's son, came to Logstown situated on a hill. On the east end is a great piece of low land, where the Old Logstown used to stand. In the new Logstown the French have built about 30 houses for the Indians. They have a large cornfield on the south side where the corn stands ungathered."

It should be remembered that the "French Logstown" was probably built over the ruins of Kakowatchiky's Logstown after it was burned in 1754 by Scarayady, an Oneida Indian loyal to the English.

Logstown was destroyed at the outbreak of the French and Indian War, so the village would not fall into French hands.

From the Baden area the trail covered about four miles to Conway where stood the Indian village of "Mingo Cabins". Here was the town of Chief Crow, this place was also known as "Crow's Town".

About three miles past Crow's Run the trail begins to arch up the steep bank to Rochester, across Case Street and Brighton Avenue. In 1772 this place was known as "Logan's Town", a small Indian village inhabited by the famous Mingo, Chief Logan. Logan was supposed to be the author of "Logan's Lament," a melancholy epitaph about the murder of his family and the evils of war. However, the written version of the "Lament" was thought to have been "doctored," after it was told to renegade Simon Girty, written down by fur trader John Gibson, then presented to the public by Thomas Jefferson.

Passing through Rochester, the Great Trail fords the Beaver River slightly below the Rochester Bridge. The trail arrives on the west side of the Beaver River just below Bridge Street in Bridgewater. At this place was Old Sawkunk, an Indian village established about 1725. After the French and Indian War, Sawkunk was also called "White Eyes Town". From Bridgewater the trail went up the bank through the city of Beaver, passing between Canal Street and Fifth Street, through Clark Park Cemetery. After crossing Two Mile Run, the trail turned northwest up the steep grade to Pleasant View, then out Tuscarawas Road about five miles, to the Lisbon Road, toward Blackhawk. After passing through what is now Seven Oaks Country Club, the route begins to criss-cross back and forth over Lisbon Road until the trail reaches the crossroads at old Salem Church on State Route 168. Once over the crossroads, the trail roughly follows Lisbon Road through South Beaver Township to the Ohio State Line.

Here the trail crosses into section 25 of Middleton Township, in Columbiana County. The Pancake-Clarkson Road follows the Great Trail